Thought and the New Antisemitism," published by the American Jewish Committee. In the spirit of George Orwell's seminal insight—"if thought corrupts language, language also corrupts thought"—I set out to examine the words of these authors and the degree to which they might be consonant with today's antisemitism, especially in its more virulent anti-Zionist forms.

I was not the first writer to look closely at Jewish authors whose statements go well beyond what most reasonable people would see as legitimate criticism of Israeli policies and actions and who call into question the very essence of the Jewish state and its right to continued existence. Writing in the pages of *The New Republic* about the late Tony Judt—who claimed that "Israel today is bad for the Jews"—Leon Wieseltier pointed out that to confuse the object of anti-Jewish hostility with its cause, as Judt did, is not to understand antisemitism but to reproduce it. Others have also analyzed the contributions of Jewish thinkers to today's anti-Zionist discourse, including Edward Alexander, Robert Wistrich (in this volume), Emanuele Ottolenghi, and Shmuel Trigano.

Yet the *New York Times* chose on January 31, 2007 to run a prominent story about my work with the headline "Essay Linking Liberal Jews to Antisemitism Sparks a Furor." In fact, prior to the *Times* article, there had been no furor. In an age of instant internet communication, though, a major story in America's leading newspaper about an alleged attack on "liberal Jews" by a Jewish professor could race around the globe and, in no time at all, unleash a bitter debate.

The debate may partly have been triggered by the *Times*' erroneous reference to "liberal Jews"—a term I never used—and to the American Jewish Committee as a "conservative advocacy group" (which it is not). Owing to these mischaracterizations, some readers were prepared to see my essay as just the latest salvo in the already overheated culture wars between right-wing and left-wing opinion in America. Before reading what I actually wrote, for instance, Gershom Gorenberg, commenting in the *American Prospect*, groaned: "Here we go again, I thought: Another right-wing American Jew. . .is trashing liberal Jews for voicing criticisms milder than what an Israeli ex-paratroop officer might express over lunch with old army friends." On closer look, though, he found something quite different: a critical review of the words of "those Jews who reject the very existence of a Jewish state and who express their opposition in shrieks that rise to equating Israel with the Nazis."

These "shrieks" were my subject; and I easily found them in the work of certain Jewish authors, many of whom identify as "progressives" and are prominently represented in Tony Kushner and Alisa Solomon's *Wrestling*

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